SRSB CareerBridge

Data Retention Report

17 October 2026

1. Overall data retention chart

Category	Examples	Kept for	Removed when
Candidate account	Login, profile, education, skills, experience, search history, photo	Life of the account	Super Admin permanent delete (Suspended or Inactive only)
Resume and ATS	Resume record, upload, PDF, ATS report, rewrite, search chunks	With the resume or account	Hard delete or candidate account delete
Employer and company	Login, company profile, GSTIN / PAN / CIN, logo	Life of the employer account	Super Admin permanent delete (blocked if any payment is above ₹0)
Jobs and hiring	Jobs, applications, interviews, shortlists, match scores, outcomes	While linked accounts exist	Candidate delete and/or employer delete
WhatsApp	Messages, phones, template, delivery times	Kept	Message row remains after account delete; person link is cleared
In-app notifications	Title, body, link, read or unread, device tokens	Until the user account is deleted	Account delete
Interviews and AI	AI mock, human mock, skill assessment, purchases, embeddings	Until the candidate account is deleted	Candidate account permanent delete
Login codes and temporary links	OTP, access and refresh tokens, signed file links, WhatsApp interview link	OTP 5 minutes; access 7 days; refresh 30 days; WhatsApp link 7 days	Code or link expires; database and file records remain
Retained after account delete	Audit log, WhatsApp log, AI cost log, GST verification log, charged payments, shared company GSTIN, backups	Indefinite (backups follow Cloud SQL retention)	No automatic purge
Platform configuration	Settings, catalogs, skill dictionary, notification templates, staff logins	Platform life	Admin change or staff delete rules

2. Overall rule

CareerBridge does not delete candidate or employer data on a timer. Profile, resume, job, application, WhatsApp, notification, interview, and assessment data remain for the life of the account.

Personal information is retained as long as required to deliver recruitment services, maintain business records, meet legal and contractual duties, and resolve disputes. The privacy policy does not set a fixed number of days or years.

Permanent removal occurs only when a Super Admin deletes a Suspended or Inactive account. An Active account cannot be deleted. An employer with any payment above ₹0 cannot be deleted.

3. Master list — every store

Store	What it holds	How long it stays
Candidate login	Phone, email, password hash, status, last login	Until the candidate account is permanently deleted
Candidate profile	Name, location, date of birth, education, skills, experience, salary, notice period, photo, career gaps, WhatsApp opt-in	Until the candidate account is permanently deleted
Job-search history	Roles and keywords the candidate searched	Until the candidate account is permanently deleted
Resume record	Title, content, raw text, score, versions	Until the resume is hard-deleted, or the candidate account is deleted
Resume files	Original upload and generated PDF in cloud storage	Same as the resume record
ATS report, facts, issues	Score breakdown, parsed facts, recommendations	Same as the resume record
AI resume rewrite	Before and after score, change list, new version	Same as the resume record
Resume search chunks	Resume text used for matching	Removed with the candidate account
In-app notifications	Title, body, link, read or unread, for that user	Until that user's account is permanently deleted
Notification templates	Admin wording for notification text	Platform data. Kept until an admin deletes the template
Device tokens	Push token for web or mobile	Until the account is deleted, or the token is replaced
WhatsApp messages	Phones, template, payload, delivery status and times	Kept. The row stays even after the candidate or interview is deleted
WhatsApp action link	Secure link inside an interview message	The message stays. The link stops working after 7 days
Saved jobs	Jobs a candidate bookmarked	Until the candidate or that job is deleted
Jobs	Description, salary, skills, screening questions, status, views	Until the employer account is permanently deleted. Closing a job does not delete it
Applications	Status, screening answers, private employer note	Until the candidate or the job is deleted
Match scores	Skills, experience, interview readiness, semantic score	Removed with the candidate, or with the employer's jobs
Employer interviews	Time, mode, meeting link, notes, feedback, reschedule	Until the candidate or the employer is deleted
Hiring outcomes	Hired, offer, rejected, withdrawn	Removed with the employer, unless a charged payment blocks deletion
Shortlists	Employer's private shortlist and note	Until the candidate, the job, or the employer is deleted
Profile view log	One row per employer, candidate, and month	Until the candidate or the employer is deleted
Employer login and profile	Company, contact, website, logo, verification	Until the employer account is permanently deleted
GSTIN, PAN, CIN	Encrypted on the employer row	Until the employer account is permanently deleted
Company GSTIN record	Encrypted GSTIN and company name, shared by staff	Can remain after one employer login is deleted
GST verification log	Each verification attempt and result	Kept. Not removed when the employer is deleted
Employer payments of ₹0	Free payment rows	Removed with the employer
Employer payments above ₹0	Charged hiring fees	Kept. They also block deletion of the employer
AI mock interview	Questions, answers, transcript, scores, report	Until the candidate account is permanently deleted
Human mock interview	Schedule, names, emails, transcript, fee, score	Until the candidate account is permanently deleted
Skill assessment	Questions, answers, score, feedback	Until the candidate account is

		permanently deleted
Assessment purchases	Credits bought and amount paid by the candidate	Until the candidate account is permanently deleted
AI cost log	Model, token counts, cost, error. Resume text is not stored here	Kept. Not removed when the user is deleted
Testimonials	Rating, quote, name, approval status, prompts	Until that user's account is permanently deleted
OTP requests	Hashed login code, phone or email, attempt count	The code works for 5 minutes. The row stays
Refresh tokens	Hashed session token	Works for 30 days by default. The row stays until the account is deleted
Audit log	Action, IP address, browser, and on deletion the name and email	Kept. No automatic cleanup
Platform settings and catalogs	Admin configuration, cities, categories, skill names	Platform data. Not a person's record
Cloud SQL backups	A copy of the database at backup time	Set on the production Cloud SQL instance

4. Candidate account

The following data remains for the life of the candidate account (Active, Suspended, or Inactive). Suspension hides access; it does not erase data.

Data	Contents
Login	Phone, email, password hash, account status, last login time
Profile	Name, city, state, preferred work city, date of birth, gender, about, photo, profile links
Career	Education, skills, experience, career gaps, certifications, projects
Preferences	Notice period, employment status, expected salary, job types, relocation, language
WhatsApp on the profile	Opt-in, opt-in time, number, verified flag
Search history	Each role or keyword searched, and when it was last searched
Onboarding	Completed flag, skipped steps, profile completion, dashboard reached

When Super Admin permanently deletes a Suspended or Inactive candidate, the login and related records are removed together: profile, education, skills, experience, career gaps, search history, applications, interviews, resumes, assessments, saved jobs, match scores, and search embeddings. Profile photo and resume files are then removed from cloud storage.

5. Resume data

A resume is stored in two places: the database row, and the file in private cloud storage.

Piece	What is kept	When it is removed
Resume row	Title, target job, template, summary, full structured content, raw extracted text, score, version, kind	Hard delete, or candidate account delete
Original file	The file the candidate uploaded	Same as the resume row
Generated PDF	The PDF CareerBridge builds from the resume	Same as the resume row
ATS report	Overall score, section scores, issue list, recommended plan	With the resume
Facts and issues	Each parsed fact and each ATS issue, with	With the resume

	the recommendation	
Rewrite history	Plan, before score, after score, improvements, the resulting version	With the source resume
Search chunks	Sections of the resume text and their vectors, used for job matching	When the candidate account is deleted

If the candidate deletes a resume from the product, the result depends on applications. A resume that no application uses is deleted at once, including its cloud file. A resume that an application still uses is archived: it leaves the candidate's active list and remains in the database so the application history stays intact. A later account deletion removes archived resumes as well.

6. Employer and company data

Data	How long
Login: phone, email, password hash, status	Until the employer account is permanently deleted
Profile: company name, industry, city, state, contact, designation, website, about, LinkedIn, size, logo, verification status	Until the employer account is permanently deleted
GSTIN, PAN, and CIN	Encrypted on the employer row, until that account is deleted
Shared company record	Encrypted GSTIN and legal name. Several staff accounts can point at one company. Deleting one employer login leaves this company row in place
GST verification attempts	Each attempt is kept: encrypted GSTIN, pass or fail, provider, and time. This log is not removed with the employer
Logo file	Removed when the employer account is permanently deleted
Payments of ₹0	Removed with the employer
Payments above ₹0	Kept. Super Admin cannot delete an employer who has any charged payment, so the jobs and profile stay with the payment history

7. Jobs, applications, and hiring

Closing, pausing, or filling a job records a status and a closed time. The job row stays. There is one application per candidate per job.

Record	Kept while	Removed when
Job	The employer account exists	The employer account is permanently deleted
Application and screening answers	Both the candidate and the job exist	The candidate is deleted, or the employer's jobs are deleted
Private employer note on an application	The application exists	The application is removed
Match score and embeddings for that job	The candidate and the job exist	The candidate is deleted, or the employer's jobs are deleted
Employer interview	The application exists	The candidate or the employer is deleted
Hiring outcome	The employer account can still be deleted	The employer is deleted. A charged payment blocks that delete
Talent shortlist	Candidate, job, and employer exist	Any one of those three is deleted
Monthly profile-view count	Candidate and employer exist	The candidate or the employer is deleted
Saved job	Candidate and job exist	The candidate or the job is deleted

Deleting a candidate removes that person's applications. The employer's jobs stay, and the employer's payment records stay. Deleting an employer removes that employer's jobs and the applications to those jobs. The candidate accounts themselves stay.

8. WhatsApp

Every WhatsApp message sent or received is stored in the database. There is no automatic cleanup of old messages.

What is stored	Detail
Phones	Destination number and, for inbound messages, the sender number
Message	Type, template name, direction (outbound or inbound), and the payload
Delivery	Status: queued, sent, delivered, read, failed, or received
Times	Created, sent, delivered, and read
Provider id	WhatsApp message id, plus any error payload
Links	Optional link to a candidate and to an employer interview

After account or interview deletion, the message row remains. The candidate or interview link is cleared; phone number and payload stay.

The secure link inside an interview WhatsApp message expires after 7 days. The message itself remains.

9. In-app notifications

Each notification is stored for one user (title, body, type, link, read time). Marking as read does not delete it. There is no cleanup of old or read notifications.

Store	How long
Notification sent to a candidate or employer	Until that user's account is permanently deleted. Read and unread rows are both kept
Push device token	Until the account is deleted, or until logout replaces that token
Notification text templates	Platform wording managed by admins. Kept until an admin deletes that template. Not tied to a user

OTP and interview emails are sent through the mail server. CareerBridge does not store a mailbox copy; the OTP hash, notification, or interview record is kept instead.

10. Interviews, assessments, and AI

Store	Contents	How long
AI mock interview	Role, questions, answers, transcript, warnings, scores, written report	Until the candidate account is permanently deleted
Human mock interview	Schedule, join token, interviewer and candidate name and email, transcript, fee, score, feedback	Until the candidate account is permanently deleted
Skill assessment	Skills, questions, answers, score, feedback	Until the candidate account is permanently deleted
Assessment credit purchase	Credits, amount in rupees, payment status	Until the candidate account is permanently deleted
AI cost log	Operation name, model, input and	Kept after the user is deleted. The

	output tokens, latency, cost, error text	resume or answer text is not in this log
Profile and resume embeddings	Vectors used to match candidates and jobs	Removed when that candidate, or that employer's jobs, are deleted

11. Login codes, sessions, and temporary links

These limits expire access only. They do not delete candidate, employer, resume, or WhatsApp records.

Item	Works for	What remains afterward
Email or mobile OTP	5 minutes, or 5 wrong attempts	The code stops working. The database keeps the hashed code, phone or email, and attempt count
Sign-in access token	7 days, unless the live service sets JWT_ACCESS_EXPIRES to another value	The user must sign in again or use the refresh token
Refresh token	30 days by the same default (JWT_REFRESH_EXPIRES)	The session ends. The token row stays until the account is deleted
Registration draft	30 minutes, in that browser only	Dropped from the browser. It is never written to the database
Resume view link	30 minutes	The resume file stays. The next open creates a new link
Profile photo link	7 days	The photo file stays. The next open creates a new link
Company logo link	60 minutes	The logo file stays. The next open creates a new link
WhatsApp interview link	7 days	The interview and the WhatsApp message stay. The link stops opening

12. What stays after an account is deleted

Record	What is still in the system
Audit log	The deletion itself, plus the name, email, role, and status that were on the account. Other audit rows (IP address, browser, action) are also kept. There is no purge
WhatsApp log	Phone numbers, template, payload, and delivery times. The link to the person is cleared
AI cost log	Model, tokens, and cost for that user id. Not removed by account deletion
GST verification log	Encrypted GSTIN and the verification result. Not removed by account deletion
Charged employer payments	Amount, status, and provider reference. Their existence blocks employer deletion
Shared company GSTIN row	Can remain when one staff login is removed and other staff still use the company
Cloud SQL backup	A deleted row can still exist inside a backup taken before the delete, until that backup ages out

After a candidate applies, the employer may also keep a copy outside CareerBridge. Retention of that copy is outside CareerBridge control.

13. Platform data

These are configuration records, not candidate or employer personal files.

- Platform settings: admin keys and values.
- Catalogs: job categories, cities, experience levels, and languages.
- Skill dictionary: shared skill names and categories.
- Notification templates: default and overridden notification wording.
- Staff accounts: admin and operator logins. A Super Admin account cannot be deleted. An admin or operator can be deleted only after that staff account is suspended or inactive. Actions they performed stay in the audit log.

14. How permanent deletion works

- Only Super Admin can permanently delete an account.
- The account must already be Suspended or Inactive. An Active account is refused.
- Candidate delete removes the person, their resumes and files, applications, interviews, assessments, notifications, sessions, and match data.
- Employer delete removes the company login, jobs, interviews, and applications to those jobs. Candidate accounts stay.
- Employer delete is refused when any payment amount is above ₹0.
- A staff member cannot delete their own account. Super Admin accounts cannot be deleted.
- The audit log of the deletion is written in the same transaction and is kept.

15. Backups

Automated Cloud SQL backups retain a copy of the database for the configured backup window. Until a backup expires, it may still contain rows that were later deleted from the live database.

16. Summary

- Candidate and employer data has no automatic end date while the account exists.
- Suspended and inactive accounts retain full data until permanent delete.
- Resumes, PDFs, ATS results, and rewrites stay with the resume.
- WhatsApp messages and the audit log remain after account deletion.
- In-app notifications remain until the user account is deleted.
- OTP, session tokens, and file links expire; underlying records remain.
- An employer with any charged payment cannot be deleted.
- Cloud SQL backups can outlive a delete for the configured backup window.